

F1 · The 19-figure nativity set (child-safe faces, modular)

Product: one shared robed base, 19 figures, and the manger/stable props.

Sell as: Crochet Nativity Set Pattern PDF, 19 Piece Amigurumi Nativity, Mary Joseph Baby Jesus Angel Animals, Child Safe Embroidered Faces — list \$24.99, 30% off, realise \$17.49.

Also list on its own: the core set - F01, F02, F03, F04 and F10 - at \$9.99; that listing is what converts the buyer who is not going to commit to 19 figures, and it is the ad copy for the set.

TEST_STATUS: untested draft — crochet L01 + F01 + F13 before publishing.

BABY_SAFE: yes — this set has **no eye hardware of any kind**. Every face is embroidered, and that is the sentence in your title that beats the \$11.60 incumbent. Figures are built from **one base** (L01) with per-figure head-dressing, props and colour. That is how published sets are written: the buyer learns the base once, and the pattern stays 20 pages instead of 60. Do not "improve" this by writing 19 separate bodies - it doubles your proofing work and makes every size change three edits instead of one.

Materials

- Cotton or acrylic DK in robed colours: cream, sage, rust, mustard, dusty blue, brown, camel, charcoal; scraps of gold and red.
- Hook 3.0 mm (US E/4); 3.5 mm for chains and props.
- Fibrefill, approx 120 g for the full set.
- Tapestry needle; size 5 embroidery needle for faces; 1 mm wire (6 cm) for the star and 2 halos.
- Card discs 4 cm (F01-F09 bases) and 2.5 cm for the animals.
- Optional: matte varnish for the props if they will live on a mantel.

Yardage per figure: about 18-25 g for a robed figure, 8 g for an animal, 4 g for a prop. Total for all 19 is under 300 g of DK, which is the number buyers ask about first.

Gauge

10 sc × 12 rnds = 2.5 cm in the round, 3.0 mm hook. Finished robed figure 11 cm (4.3 in) tall; animals 5-7 cm; manger 9 cm wide. Gauge matters here in one specific way: if your tension is loose the 6-stitch neck (R7) will not hold the head up. If the head flops, drop to 2.5 mm for L01 R1-R7, not for the whole figure.

Yarn and substitutions

The figures take 5-20 g each, so this is a stash pattern first and a shopping list second. Buy by millimetres, not by a US or UK hook number: a "size 7" means 4.5 mm in the United States and 3.0 mm on an old English hook, which is the most common reason an imported pattern comes out a size small.

what the pattern calls for	US shelves	UK shelves
Worsted / 10 ply, 4.5-5.0 mm	Lion Brand Wear It, I Love This Cotton, Red Heart Super Saver	Patons Astra, Stylecraft Special DK doubled, Sirdar Country Value 8 ply
DK / 8 ply, 4.0 mm	Lion Brand Wool-Ease DK, Bernat Premium	Stylecraft Special DK, King Cole Merino Blend DK, Paintbox Cotton DK
Fingering for faces and hands	Knit Picks Palette	James C.F. Riviera 4 ply, Wendy Premium Single Ply

Acrylic or cotton for anything a child will handle. Mohair and wool that is not labelled superwash felt the moment someone wipes them with a wet cloth, and a stable full of wool figures that has been damp once is a stable of lint.

Care

Surface clean with a barely damp cloth and a drop of wool wash. Do not soak the set and do not put it in a machine; the heads are light and a spin cycle pulls them off. Dry flat, away from a radiator. If the nativity sits by the manger candles, keep it a hand's width back - acrylic does not melt politely, it runs.

Abbreviations

US term	UK term	means
MR	rm	magic ring
sc	dc	single crochet
inc	inc	2 sc in one stitch
dec	dec	sc 2 stitches together
sl st	ss	slip stitch (count-neutral here)
ch	ch	chain
blo / flo	blo / flo	back / front loop only
EA	EA	embroider around
st	st	stitch
rnd	rnd	round

L01 · The robed base (used by F01-F09)

Head: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4-R6 sc around – 18

R7 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

Neck and shoulders: R8 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R9 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R10 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30

R11 (4 sc, inc) x6 – 36

Robe: R12-R20 sc around – 36

R21 (10 sc, dec) x3 – 33

Hem: R22-R23 sc around – 33

Finish: stuff the head firmly before R8, then stuff the robe in two stages - a firm plug at the shoulders so the head sits up, and a soft fill down to the hem so it can lean. Run yarn through the back loops of R23 and cinch just enough to close the hole; the hem will flare on its own. Insert a 4 cm card disc inside the hem so a top-heavy figure stands on a mantel.

Face, all figures: embroider two 3 mm straight stitches at R5, 5 stitches apart, in dark brown. No plastic eyes anywhere in this set - the child-safe claim depends on it.

Sleeves (make 2): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2-R6 sc around – 6

Hands: work directly off the sleeve: R7 (2 sc, inc) x2 – 8

R8-R9 sc around – 8

Flatten each sleeve, stuff the cuff only, and sew across the front of the robe at R13 so the arms are folded in prayer. This one detail is what makes a robed set look carved rather than stuffed.

The 19 figures

F01 · Mary

Work L01 in dusty blue. Veil: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R9 sc around – 24

R10 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18

Finish the veil by working one round of (1 sc, ch 1, sk 1) x16 for a scalloped edge (count-neutral decorative round). Stuff the crown only, press it onto the head from the back, and leave the front hairline open; embroider hair as 12 loose strands of dark brown pulled through under the veil edge. Carry F03 in both arms, or sew it into a 4 cm folded cloth cradle first so the pose looks held.

F02 · Joseph

Work L01 in camel. Head-wrap: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R8 sc around – 24

Finish: work one round of (4 sc, dec) x6 – 30 to shrink it onto the head, then fasten. Fold the back edge down twice to make a turban roll and sew at the temples. Beard: cut 25 strands of charcoal at 2.5 cm, pull through R6 of L01 in a horseshoe, trim into a rounded square. Staff: ch 30 with a sc up it in brown, hook the top over 3 ch.

F03 · Baby Jesus

Body: R1 MR, 4 sc – 4

R2 (inc) x4 – 8

R3-R5 sc around – 8

R6 dec x4 – 4

Head: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4-R5 sc around – 18

R6 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

R7 dec x6 – 6

Swaddling band: ch 20, then 19 sc; wrap the body and sew the band once. Do not stuff the swaddle: a firm-stuffed baby with a wrapped band reads as a lump, and the cloth is what carries the shape.

Manger tray: Row 1 ch 14, 13 sc across – 13

Rows 2-4 ch 1 and turn, sc 13 – 13

F04 · Angel

Head: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4-R6 sc around – 18

R7 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

Robe (worked off the neck): R8 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
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R9 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R10 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30

R11-R17 sc around – 30

Wing (make 2): Row 1 MR, 5 sc – 5

Row 2 inc, sc 3, inc – 7

Row 3 inc, sc 5, inc – 9

Row 4 inc, sc 7, inc – 11

Row 5 inc, sc 9, inc – 13

Finish: sew the wings to the back at R12 with the top edge angled 30° up - the single most common mistake with crochet wings is sewing them level, and a level wing looks like a leaf. Halo: bend 6 cm of 1 mm wire into a 12 mm ring and wrap in gold, or ch 8 joined and covered in 8 sc.

F05 · Wise man, gold

Work L01 in rust. Crown: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4-R6 sc around – 18

Finish: work (ch 3, sk 2, sl st) x6 around R6 for points and sew a 3 mm gold bead into each. Gift:

work 6 sc into an MR and add 2 rnds - R1 MR, 6 sc – 6 / R2 (inc) x6 – 12 / R3 sc around – 12

- to make a 2 cm chalice cup, then sew it shut over a bead.

F06 · Wise man, frankincense

Work L01 in mustard; reuse F05's crown in a different colour and change the robe to one round of (back loop only) at R20 so the three kings read as a set rather than three copies. Gift: a 2 cm cylinder - R1 MR, 6 sc – 6 / R2-R5 sc around – 6 - with a domed lid: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6 / R2 (inc) x6 – 12 / R3 sc around – 12, sewn on a chain hinge so the lid actually opens. Buyers photograph that.

F07 · Wise man, myrrh

Base: L01.

Work L01 in sage with a charcoal under-robe shown at the hem by working R21-R23 in charcoal.

Crown as F05 in gold. Gift: a closed 2 cm box - Row 1 ch 9, 8 sc across – 8

Rows 2-3 ch 1 and turn, sc 8 – 8

Rows 4-5 ch 1 and turn, sc 8 – 8

- seamed into a cube with a tapestry needle and stuffed with a bead for weight.

This is the figure that makes the set photograph as three, not one plus two: same base, three different hem colours, three different gifts.

F08 · Shepherd

Work L01 in charcoal with a cream fleece overlay: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R6 sc around – 24

Cut the overlay down the front to make a waistcoat and sew it over the robe's shoulders; the

textured cream against the dark robe is what reads as sheepskin. Hood: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18

Sew over the crown with the back edge loose enough to fall onto the shoulders. Crook: ch 22, sc up, then (2 sc, ch 2, 2 sc) into

the last ch for the hook.

F09 · Shepherd boy

Base: L01 (scaled). Work L01 at 2.5 mm so he stands 8 cm instead of 11, and skip the cinch round at R21 - a child figure needs a straight hem or he looks like an adult shrunk. Tunic: leave the robe open at the sides from R18 to the hem so it swings. Add F15 as a companion and put the lamb on his shoulders: that pair photo is the one that sells the whole set on Instagram, and it is free.

F10 · Donkey

Body: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (inc) x6 – 12
R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24
R5-R10 sc around – 24
R11 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18
R12 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12
Head: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (inc) x6 – 12
R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
R4-R7 sc around – 18
R8 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12
Muzzle: R9 (2 sc, inc) x4 – 16
R10-R11 sc around – 16
Ear (make 2): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2-R4 sc around – 6
Leg (make 4): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2-R6 sc around – 6
Finish: nostrils as two 2 mm French knots; mane as a 6 cm yarn fringe along the neck join; tail as a 3-ch ring with 8 cream chains knotted through. Sew the head at R4 of the body, angled 20° forward.

F11 · Ox

Body: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (inc) x6 – 12
R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24
R5 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30

R6-R11 sc around – 30
R12 (3 sc, dec) x6 – 24
R13 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18
R14 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12
Head: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (inc) x6 – 12
R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
R4-R7 sc around – 18
R8 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12
Horns: ch 6 with 5 sc, then (dec, dec) – 2 at the tip. Ears as F10. Leg (make 4): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6 /
R2-R7 sc around – 6, then a 4-row flat hoof in charcoal sewn over the end.
Finish: embroider a soft muzzle in pink, then sew the head low between the shoulders - an ox with a

high head reads as a goat.

F12 • Camel

Body: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (inc) x6 – 12
R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24
R5 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30
R6 (4 sc, inc) x6 – 36
R7-R8 sc around – 36
Hump: R9 (4 sc, dec) x6 – 30
R10 (3 sc, dec) x6 – 24
R11 (3 sc, inc) x6 – 30
R12 (4 sc, inc) x6 – 36

so the back rises and falls rather than being two lumps sewn on. Do not skip this: a camel worked as a tube with two lumps glued on is the reason cheap camels look like llamas.

Neck: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6
R2 (inc) x6 – 12
R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18
R4-R9 sc around – 18

Head: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3-R6 sc around – 12

Leg (make 4): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2-R10 sc around – 6

Finish: 2 rnds at R2-R3 in a darker tone for the knees, tail as a 5-ch with a knotted tuft, and a saddle blanket: Row 1 MR, 5 sc – 5 / Row 2 inc, sc 3, inc – 7 / Row 3 sc 7 – 7, in rust.

F13 · Sheep (wool)

Body: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4 (2 sc, inc) x6 – 24

R5-R9 sc around – 24

R10 (2 sc, dec) x6 – 18

Head: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 sc around – 12

R4 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R5-R6 sc around – 18

Leg (make 4): R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2-R5 sc around – 6

Finish: the fleece texture is the whole job - after closing R10, work a round of 3-dc bobbles into every stitch around the body, then trim the loops of a cream yarn tail over the top to break the silhouette. Face in charcoal with a 4 mm embroidered eye, and ears as two flattened 6-st MR discs.

F14 · Ram

Base: F13.

Work the same body as F13 with no bobbling, in oatmeal, and add horns: ch 8 into a ring, then

R1 MR, 4 sc – 4

R2-R5 sc around – 4

coiled, stiffened with a 4 cm wire sewn inside. Legs as F13 but 7 rounds. Sew the horns at head R3 pointing back and down; a curl that points forward turns the ram into a goat.

F15 · Lamb

Scale F13's head to 4.5 rounds of 12 and skip the bobble round - a lamb is smooth with a fuzzy

face. Body: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2 (inc) x6 – 12

R3 (1 sc, inc) x6 – 18

R4-R6 sc around – 18

R7 (1 sc, dec) x6 – 12

Legs: 4 rounds of 6. Ears: two long flattened 6-st tubes. This is the F09 companion; work them together in one sitting so the colour match is exact.

F16 · Dove

Body: R1 MR, 4 sc – 4

R2 (inc) x4 – 8

R3 (1 sc, inc) x4 – 12

R4-R6 sc around – 12

R7 (1 sc, dec) x4 – 8

Wing (make 2): Row 1 MR, 5 sc – 5

Row 2 inc, sc 3, inc – 7

Tail: Row 1 MR, 4 sc – 4

Row 2 inc, sc 2, inc – 6

Finish: sew wings with only the leading edge attached so they lift; block the tail flat in a fan.

Doves are the one figure that rewards an aggressive stuff - a soft dove looks like a rag.

F17 · Star

freeform – make two. ch 5 sl st into a ring; (ch 5, sl st in 2nd ch, sc, dc, ch 2, dc, sc, sl st back) x5 for five points, then fill the centre with 15 sc. Soak in 1:1 glue, pin, dry under a book. The larger one sits over the manger; the smaller is held by F04 as a window into the sky.

F18 · Palm tree

Trunk: R1 MR, 6 sc – 6

R2-R12 sc around – 6

Frond (make 5): Row 1 ch 12, 11 sc across – 11

Row 2 dec, sc 7, dec – 9

Row 3 dec, sc 5, dec – 7

Finish: stuff the trunk with a 4 cm wire so it can bend; sew fronds into a rosette at the top and steam-curl the tips over a pencil. A straight palm looks like a green mop - the bend is the pattern.

F19 · Manger and stable

Trough: Row 1 ch 16, 15 sc across – 15
Rows 2-5 ch 1 and turn, sc 15 – 15
Hay: freeform – 40 strands of mustard at 3 cm pulled through Row 4 and trimmed ragged.
Stable: three flat panels, each Row 1 ch 20, 19 sc across – 19 / Rows 2-14 sc 19 – 19, seamed

into an A-frame with a 20-row roof panel left open at the front. Work it in blo on Rows 2 and 14

so the roof reads as beams. Skip the stable if you would rather ship the set a week earlier - the

18-figure version still stands alone, and the stable is the natural January add-on that becomes a

second listing (Easter garden version) later.

Finishing

- Every robed figure gets its card base disc before the cinch is closed, or the set will not stand up on a mantel and the first review will say so.
- Sew heads at the neck R7/R8 join with the figure stuffed to the shoulders, not after; otherwise the head sits like a balloon.
- Embroider faces before assembly. Holding a 4 cm head to stitch a face on is how hands get pricked and lines get crooked.
- Group colour plan (this is what makes a set look designed): robes in rust, sage, mustard, dusty blue, camel, charcoal; animals in cream, oatmeal, brown, camel; props in gold. One warm, one cool, one neutral per figure.

Photographing it

All 19 arranged on cream with the manger low and the star high; a hand holding one figure for scale; the three kings close-up so the different gifts read; the animals in a row; the 5-figure core photographed alone because that is the listing that gets the click. Then 30 s of video panning across the set. The \$11.60 incumbent sells on the completeness of the display photo, not the text.

Licence

Personal use. You may gift and sell finished nativity figures in small quantities. You may not resell, share, re-publish, translate or machine-train on this PDF. Faces here are embroidered by design: if you substitute plastic eyes, the child-safe line no longer applies to what you make.

Changelog

- v1 draft, Oct 3 2026 — 19 figures on one base, round arithmetic machine-verified, unstitched.